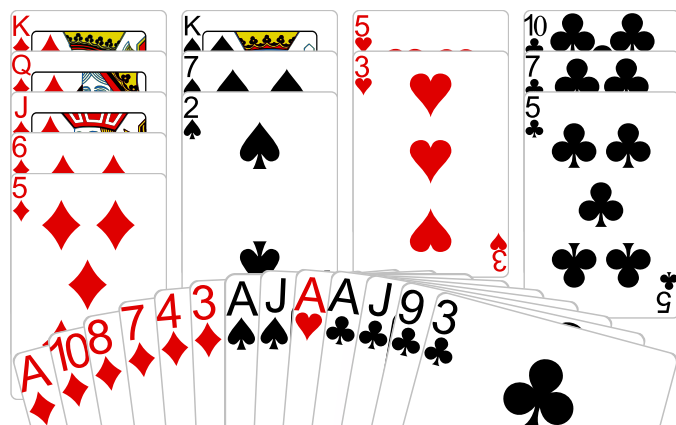
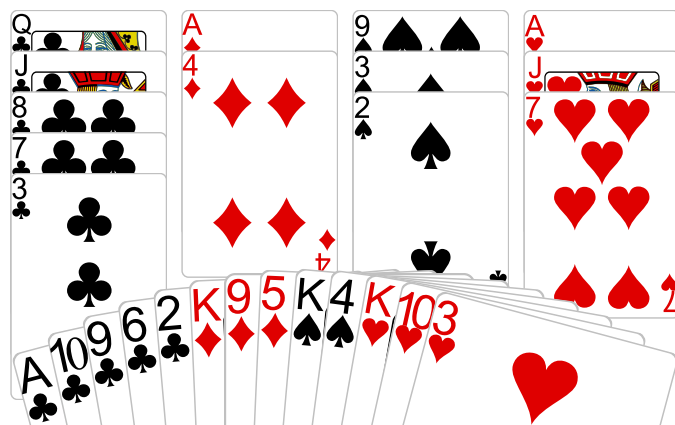


Deal 1 Ctr: 6♦ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 5♣ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6 

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 5 

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6 

Declarer: South

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

West

Pass

Dbl

All Pass

North

1♦

6♦

East

1♥

South

2♥

6♦ by North

You want to play the first ♣ from dummy, so enter dummy with a trump.

Play the ♣10 from dummy and let it ride if West does not produce the ♣Q or ♣K. East will win with one of the honors but will have to return another ♣ or give you a ruff-sluff.

When you are missing the K Q of a suit, as in the ♣s on this hand, taking two finesses gives you a 75% chance of success - **all things being equal**.

In this case though, East's overcall means all things are not equal, so your chances are lower than 75%.

But never mind the percentages for a finesse, the end-play was a sure thing.

South's 2♥ bid showed a hand with limit raise or better in ♦s. North doesn't bother with Blackwood since he already knows about the Aces. He just bids the slam. North plays 6♦. East leads the ♥K, won by you with the ♥A.

The good news is that you have no losers in ♠s, ♥, or ♦s. The bad news is that you have two losers in ♣s. The good news is that missing the ♣ K Q you could try two finesses. The bad news is that East overcalled, so he probably has both honors. The best news of all is that you know how to pull off an elimination play!. Play a trump to dummy's ♦K (East discards a ♥) and ruff the ♥5.

Pull the outstanding trump with the ♦A, then play ♠A, ♠K and ruff a ♠.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3 2
 ♥ A J 7
 ♦ A 4
 ♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ Q 9 8 2
 ♦ 10 8 7 6 2
 ♣ 5



♠ K 4
 ♥ K 10 3
 ♦ K 9 5
 ♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7
 ♥ 6 5 4
 ♦ Q J 3
 ♣ K 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	1 ♠
2 ♠	Pass	3 ♣	Pass
5 ♣			
All Pass			
5 ♣ by East			

West's cue-bid shows a limit raise or better (11 points) in ♣s. East is to play 5 ♣. South leads the ♠Q, North takes the ♠A and returns the ♠6 to your ♠K.

You have lost one trick already and have a possible loser in trumps and another possible loser in ♥s. Both losers can be avoided with successful finesses. The problem with the ♣ finesse is that South made an overcall so he is more likely to hold the ♣K. If you don't try the ♣ finesse you may be able to throw a defender in with the ♣K at a time when he will have to help you with his next play.

After winning the ♠K immediately play the ♣A.

It would have been nice to see the ♣K fall, but it didn't. So play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦A and play the ♠9, ruffing in your hand.

Eliminate the ♦s by playing ♦K, then ruffing your last ♦ in dummy.

You have done all the eliminating, time to throw in somebody. Play a ♣.

Whichever defender had the ♣K is now on lead, but wishes he wasn't. If he plays a ♥ you get a free finesse. If he plays anything else you get a ruff-sluff.

If you had finessed for the ♣K South would have won the trick and been able to make a safe exit, probably with his other ♣.

You would then have been forced to rely on the ♥ finesse, and with South being the defender who showed some strength, you would likely have finessed through him.

About the only way the elimination/throw-in could fail is if the ♣s split 3-0. Then, if you play Ace and another the defender who wins would use his third ♣ as a safe exit.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥	Pass	5♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South

Conveniently in dummy, you play a ♣ and insert the ♣10 if East plays low.

[showcards N:HA,H6,C7,C6 S:HK,HQ,CA,CQ]

West will probably win this trick. If he wins with the ♣K then your hand is good. If he wins with the ♣J then he is end-played, forced to either lead a ♣ into your ♣ A Q or to give you a ruff-sluff.

You probably noticed that you could have finessed your ♣Q on the first ♣ play and pulled off the end-play just as effectively. But there is an advantage to making the first finesse with the ♣10.

If East just happens to hold both the ♣K and ♣J you will make all thirteen tricks if your first finesse is with the ♣10!

Your 3♥ bid is a slam suggestion. After you show the ♣A partner wastes no time in bidding it.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠K.

This is a good slam. You have only two possible ♣ losers, and by taking two ♣ finesses you have an excellent chance of success. But by using an elimination play you will have a sure thing.

Win the ♠A and ruff a ♠ with a ♥ honor.

Play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥9 and ruff another ♠. Both defenders followed to the trump play.

Play another ♥ to dummy's ♥10 and ruff the last ♠.

Play the ♦A and ♦K.